

# SYNOPSIS

## Title of the Study

**Hybrid Learning and Training Effectiveness: Making Digital and In-Person Learning Work Together – A Study of Employees in an Indian Public Sector Bank**

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## 1. Introduction

The banking sector is undergoing rapid technological and organizational transformation. Digital banking, automation, artificial intelligence, regulatory changes, cybersecurity requirements and changing customer expectations have increased the need for continuous employee learning and skill development. Consequently, banks are increasingly relying on technology-enabled training alongside conventional classroom-based training.

Traditional face-to-face training provides opportunities for direct interaction, instructor guidance, discussion, demonstration and practical clarification. Digital learning, on the other hand, provides flexibility, accessibility, self-paced learning and opportunities for continuous learning beyond the classroom. Hybrid learning combines these two approaches with the intention of obtaining the advantages of both.

However, simply combining online and classroom components does not necessarily ensure effective learning. The effectiveness of hybrid learning may depend on how employees engage with the learning process, their motivation and readiness to use digital technologies, the competence of trainers, the quality of learning content, organizational support and their ability to retain and apply acquired knowledge.

Therefore, the present study proposes to examine hybrid learning not merely as a training delivery method but as a learning system in which digital and face-to-face components interact to influence training effectiveness.

Earlier research has established the importance of training effectiveness in Indian banking. Jain and Jain found that training effectiveness in Indian banks can be understood through dimensions including participation, access to training opportunities, training relevance, benefits and satisfaction. More recent research in workplace blended learning has examined learner engagement and identified factors such as acceptance of blended learning and instructor competence as important influences on engagement.

Despite this growing body of research, there remains scope for examining the mechanisms through which hybrid learning contributes to training effectiveness specifically in the context of employees of Indian public sector banks.

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## 2. Background of the Study

The transition from predominantly classroom-based training towards technology-supported learning has accelerated the adoption of digital learning platforms by organizations. In banking, employees increasingly encounter a combination of classroom programmes, virtual instructor-led sessions, e-learning modules, learning management systems, webinars, assessments and workplace learning.

Hybrid learning therefore represents a shift from the question:

**“Which training method is better – online or classroom?”**

to a more important question:

**“How can digital and face-to-face learning components be integrated so that they produce better training outcomes?”**

Research on workplace training suggests that purely digital learning may not always produce the desired outcomes and that combining digital and human elements can improve training effectiveness. A study of workplace training methodologies found that hybrid training could recover effectiveness relative to purely digital training while retaining some advantages of technology-enabled learning.

Similarly, research involving bank employees has demonstrated that both pre-training and post-training factors can significantly influence training effectiveness, indicating that training outcomes are shaped by more than the training delivery method itself.

This provides the basis for examining the factors that explain the relationship between hybrid learning and training effectiveness.

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## 3. Statement of the Problem

Indian public sector banks invest substantial resources in employee training to develop technical, managerial, digital and behavioural competencies. However, the increasing use of digital and hybrid training creates an important managerial and research question: **Does the integration of digital and face-to-face learning actually improve training effectiveness, and what factors determine whether such integration succeeds?**

A hybrid programme may provide flexibility and accessibility but may fail to achieve its intended outcomes if employees are not sufficiently motivated or engaged. Similarly, technically sophisticated digital learning may have limited value if employees lack technology readiness or if trainers are unable to effectively integrate digital and classroom learning.

Therefore, the problem addressed by this study is:

To examine the relationship between hybrid learning and training effectiveness and to identify the learner-related, trainer-related and organizational factors through which hybrid learning contributes to effective employee training in an Indian public sector bank.

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## 4. Research Gap

The review of existing literature indicates four important gaps.

### Gap 1: From training mode to training mechanism

Existing studies frequently examine online, face-to-face or blended learning as alternative training methods. However, less attention is given to understanding **why and through which mechanisms hybrid learning influences training effectiveness**.

### Gap 2: Limited banking-specific evidence

Although training effectiveness has been examined in Indian banks, relatively limited research integrates the emerging concept of hybrid learning with the specific training environment of Indian public sector banks.

### Gap 3: Importance of intervening factors

Recent workplace research suggests that learner engagement, instructor competence, motivation and support may influence learning outcomes. However, these factors are often studied independently rather than within an integrated model of hybrid learning and training effectiveness.

### Gap 4: Digital transformation of banking

The changing nature of banking requires employees to continuously acquire and apply new knowledge. Hence, there is a need for research that evaluates whether current hybrid training arrangements support not only learning and satisfaction but also **knowledge retention, application and overall training effectiveness**.

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## 5. Conceptual Focus of the Study

The study will examine **Hybrid Learning** as the primary independent variable and **Training Effectiveness** as the dependent variable.

The relationship may be explained through selected intervening factors:

**Hybrid Learning → Learner Engagement → Training Effectiveness**

**Hybrid Learning → Learning Motivation → Training Effectiveness**

## **Hybrid Learning → Knowledge Retention → Training Effectiveness**

The study may also examine whether factors such as **trainer competence, technology readiness and organizational support** strengthen or influence this relationship.

A proposed conceptual structure is:

### **Hybrid Learning**



**Learner Engagement**  
**Learning Motivation**  
**Knowledge Retention**



### **Training Effectiveness**

with **Trainer Competence, Technology Readiness and Organizational Support** considered as contextual/enabling factors.

The final model will be refined after a systematic review of literature and empirical validation.

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## **6. Variables of the Study**

### **Independent Variable**

#### **Hybrid Learning**

Possible dimensions include:

- Integration of online and face-to-face learning
- Flexibility and accessibility
- Quality of digital learning resources
- Interaction between digital and classroom components
- Continuity between online and classroom activities

### **Intervening/Mediating Variables**

#### **Learner Engagement**

- Participation
- Attention and involvement
- Interaction

- Active learning

### **Learning Motivation**

- Willingness to learn
- Interest in training
- Goal orientation
- Persistence

### **Knowledge Retention**

- Recall of training content
- Understanding
- Long-term retention
- Ability to remember relevant concepts

### **Contextual/Enabling Variables**

#### **Trainer Competence**

- Subject knowledge
- Digital competence
- Facilitation ability
- Ability to integrate online and classroom learning

#### **Technology Readiness**

- Confidence in using digital platforms
- Ease of technology use
- Adaptability to new learning technologies
- Access to required technology

#### **Organizational Support**

- Management support
- Technical support
- Time availability
- Encouragement for training participation
- Opportunities to apply learning

### **Dependent Variable**

#### **Training Effectiveness**

Possible dimensions:

- Learning achievement
- Training satisfaction
- Knowledge/skill improvement

- Application of learning at work
  - Perceived improvement in job performance
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## **7. Objectives of the Study**

### **Primary Objective**

To examine the influence of hybrid learning on training effectiveness among employees of an Indian public sector bank.

### **Specific Objectives**

1. To examine the existing pattern and extent of hybrid learning practices in employee training in the selected public sector bank.
  2. To assess the level of training effectiveness perceived by employees participating in hybrid training programmes.
  3. To examine the relationship between hybrid learning and training effectiveness.
  4. To examine the influence of learner engagement on training effectiveness.
  5. To examine the influence of learning motivation on training effectiveness.
  6. To examine the influence of knowledge retention on training effectiveness.
  7. To examine the role of trainer competence in hybrid learning and training effectiveness.
  8. To examine the role of employees' technology readiness in hybrid learning effectiveness.
  9. To examine the role of organizational support in facilitating effective hybrid learning.
  10. To develop and empirically validate an integrated framework explaining how hybrid learning contributes to training effectiveness in the context of an Indian public sector bank.
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## **8. Research Questions**

The study will seek answers to the following questions:

1. What is the nature and extent of hybrid learning practices adopted by the selected public sector bank?

2. What is the perceived level of training effectiveness among employees participating in hybrid training?
  3. Does hybrid learning significantly influence training effectiveness?
  4. Does learner engagement influence training effectiveness?
  5. Does learning motivation influence training effectiveness?
  6. Does knowledge retention influence training effectiveness?
  7. What role does trainer competence play in hybrid training effectiveness?
  8. Does technology readiness influence employees' experience and outcomes of hybrid learning?
  9. Does organizational support contribute to effective hybrid learning?
  10. Which factors best explain the relationship between hybrid learning and training effectiveness?
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## 9. Hypotheses

The following hypotheses may be tested after finalizing the conceptual model through the literature review:

- H1:** Hybrid learning has a significant positive relationship with training effectiveness.
- H2:** Hybrid learning has a significant positive relationship with learner engagement.
- H3:** Learner engagement has a significant positive relationship with training effectiveness.
- H4:** Hybrid learning has a significant positive relationship with learning motivation.
- H5:** Learning motivation has a significant positive relationship with training effectiveness.
- H6:** Hybrid learning has a significant positive relationship with knowledge retention.
- H7:** Knowledge retention has a significant positive relationship with training effectiveness.
- H8:** Trainer competence has a significant positive relationship with learner engagement in hybrid learning.
- H9:** Technology readiness has a significant positive relationship with employees' effectiveness in hybrid learning.
- H10:** Organizational support has a significant positive relationship with training effectiveness.

**H11:** Learner engagement mediates the relationship between hybrid learning and training effectiveness.

**H12:** Learning motivation mediates the relationship between hybrid learning and training effectiveness.

**H13:** Knowledge retention mediates the relationship between hybrid learning and training effectiveness.

These hypotheses will be refined following the systematic review of relevant theoretical and empirical literature.

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## 10. Theoretical Foundation

The study can be anchored in established learning and training theories rather than treating hybrid learning as an isolated concept.

The theoretical framework may draw upon:

### 10.1 Social Learning Theory

Social interaction, observation and feedback are important components of learning. Face-to-face learning can provide social interaction while digital platforms can extend learning beyond the classroom.

### 10.2 Self-Determination Theory

Learners' motivation is influenced by autonomy, competence and relatedness. Hybrid learning may support these needs through flexible learning pathways, opportunities for interaction and learner control.

### 10.3 Technology Acceptance / Technology Readiness Perspective

Employees' willingness and ability to use digital learning technologies can influence their participation and experience in hybrid learning.

### 10.4 Training Transfer Perspective

Training effectiveness should extend beyond completion or satisfaction and include the ability to retain and apply acquired knowledge and skills in the workplace.

The final theoretical framework will be selected after a detailed review of literature to ensure conceptual coherence and avoid incorporating variables merely because they are commonly used.

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## 11. Research Methodology

### Research Design

The study will adopt a **descriptive and explanatory quantitative research design**.



A quantitative approach is appropriate because the study seeks to measure relationships among hybrid learning, learner-related factors and training effectiveness and empirically test the proposed hypotheses.

## **Population**

The population will consist of employees of the selected Indian public sector bank who have participated in training programmes involving digital/online and face-to-face learning components.

## **Sampling**

A suitable sampling technique will be selected based on the accessibility and structure of the employee population.

The sample size will be determined using an appropriate statistical method, considering the number of constructs and proposed relationships in the model.

## **Data Collection**

Primary data will be collected through a structured questionnaire administered to employees who have experience with hybrid training.

The questionnaire will contain sections relating to:

1. Demographic and professional characteristics
2. Hybrid learning experience
3. Learner engagement
4. Learning motivation
5. Knowledge retention
6. Trainer competence
7. Technology readiness
8. Organizational support
9. Training effectiveness

Existing validated scales from previous studies will be adapted wherever appropriate. The questionnaire will be subjected to expert review and pilot testing before final administration.

## **Data Analysis**

The collected data may be analyzed using:

- Descriptive statistics
- Reliability analysis
- Exploratory Factor Analysis, where required
- Confirmatory Factor Analysis, where appropriate
- Correlation analysis
- Multiple regression
- Mediation analysis

- Structural Equation Modelling (SEM/PLS-SEM), depending on the final research model and sample characteristics

Appropriate tests will be used to assess reliability, validity and the proposed relationships among constructs.

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## **12. Scope of the Study**

The study will focus on employees of an Indian public sector bank who have experience with hybrid learning or blended training programmes.

The study will concentrate on the effectiveness of combining digital and face-to-face learning rather than evaluating digital learning or classroom training independently.

The study will primarily examine employee perceptions and learning-related outcomes. Organizational-level outcomes such as return on investment may fall outside the scope unless suitable organizational data are available.

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## **13. Significance of the Study**

### **Academic Significance**

The study will contribute to the literature by developing an integrated understanding of the relationship between hybrid learning and training effectiveness. Rather than treating hybrid learning simply as a training delivery mode, it will investigate the mechanisms through which hybrid learning may influence outcomes.

### **Organizational Significance**

The findings may help public sector banks identify the conditions under which hybrid training is most effective. The study may provide insights into:

- Designing better digital and classroom combinations
- Improving employee engagement
- Strengthening learner motivation
- Improving knowledge retention
- Developing trainer capabilities
- Improving employees' digital readiness
- Strengthening organizational support for training

### **Managerial Significance**

The findings can assist HR and learning-and-development managers in making evidence-based decisions about the design, implementation and evaluation of hybrid training programmes.

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## 14. Expected Contribution

The study is expected to contribute an empirically validated framework explaining the relationship between hybrid learning and training effectiveness.

Instead of concluding simply that **“hybrid learning is effective,”** the study aims to answer the more meaningful question:

**“What makes hybrid learning effective?”**

The expected contribution is therefore a model that identifies the learner, trainer, technology and organizational factors that influence the effectiveness of combining digital and face-to-face learning.

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## 15. Tentative Chapter Scheme

### Chapter 1 – Introduction

- Background of the study
- Banking-sector context
- Evolution of employee training
- Emergence of hybrid learning
- Problem statement
- Research gap
- Objectives
- Research questions
- Hypotheses
- Scope
- Significance

### Chapter 2 – Review of Literature

- Concept of learning and employee training
- Traditional training
- E-learning
- Blended/hybrid learning
- Hybrid learning in workplace training
- Training effectiveness
- Learner engagement
- Learning motivation
- Knowledge retention
- Trainer competence
- Technology readiness
- Organizational support
- Review of empirical studies

- Research gap
- Theoretical framework
- Conceptual framework

### **Chapter 3 – Research Methodology**

- Research design
- Population
- Sampling
- Sample size
- Variables
- Measurement scales
- Questionnaire development
- Pilot study
- Data collection
- Reliability and validity
- Statistical techniques

### **Chapter 4 – Data Analysis and Results**

- Respondent profile
- Descriptive analysis
- Measurement model
- Reliability and validity
- Hypothesis testing
- Mediation/moderation analysis
- Structural model
- Findings

### **Chapter 5 – Discussion, Conclusions and Recommendations**

- Discussion of findings
- Theoretical implications
- Managerial implications
- Recommendations for public sector banks
- Limitations
- Scope for future research
- Conclusion

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## **16. Tentative Conclusion**

Hybrid learning represents an important development in employee training because it has the potential to combine the flexibility and accessibility of digital learning with the interaction, guidance and experiential benefits of face-to-face learning. However, the effectiveness of hybrid learning cannot be assumed merely from the presence of both modes.

The proposed study therefore seeks to investigate the mechanisms and conditions that make hybrid learning effective in the context of an Indian public sector bank. By examining learner engagement, learning motivation, knowledge retention and relevant trainer, technology and organizational factors, the study aims to provide a more comprehensive explanation of training effectiveness.

The study is expected to provide both theoretical and practical insights for designing hybrid training programmes that are not only technologically enabled but also learner-centred, engaging, transferable and effective.